

08-12-2025 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1xPjHF1ZBks
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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Muncie Community Schools board was called to order by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Dr. Washburn, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Low. (Mr. Heater arrived later due to traffic).
 - **Absent:** Mrs. Spartans Griffin (out of state). A quorum was confirmed.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified as the board president/chair.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes disposition was handled via the consent agenda.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:13:00 2026 Budget: Permission to Advertise**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome (Chief Financial Officer / Financial Consultant)
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Derome presented the permission to advertise the 2026 budget, outlining state guidelines, timelines (public hearing on August 26, adoption on September 9), and an 18-month spending scope. The budget encompasses the Education Fund, Operation Fund, Debt Service, and Rainy Day funds. Key highlights included stable student enrollment projections (~4,872), an education fund budget of roughly \$43.6 million, an operation fund advertising of \$12.3 million (noting savings from bringing transportation in-house via SSC), and a decreasing long-term debt trend (down from \$38.5 million in 2018 to \$18.9 million). Board members discussed future fiscal challenges, including tax caps, circuit breaker impacts, and potential future legislative pressures from Senate Bill 1.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:52:47 2024-2025 Teacher Compensation Recommendations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Heater (Compensation Committee Chair) / Dr. Reynolds / Mr. Derome
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The compensation committee recommended a package raising starting teacher pay to \$52,000 (placing it in the top 8% statewide), providing a \$500 base increase for all teachers to mitigate pay compression, an additional \$1,500 for highly effective teachers (total \$2,000 increase), and \$750 for effective teachers (total \$1,250 increase). The plan also maintains a \$1,000 base salary increase for school and district teachers of the year. Board members praised the district's 90% teacher retention rate and noted that base teacher pay has risen from \$34,000 in 2018.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:58:38 Bond Project: Proof of Notice Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Leadership / Mr. Derome
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Formal procedural approval confirming that statutory public notices for the upcoming lease hearing and bond project had been legally published.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:58:38 Public Hearing Regarding Proposed Lease (Bond Projects)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The statutory lease hearing was opened to review proposed capital projects including Muncie Fieldhouse roof/boiler/air conditioning upgrades and lower arena bleachers, Muncie Southside track and tennis courts, North Side Middle School bleachers and chiller, and Muncie Central High School exterior doors and flooring and whether the proposed lease rental is fair and reasonable.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** 01:02:52 The presiding officer called for public comment multiple times; no members of the public stepped forward to speak.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Public hearing closed.
- **01:03:36 Resolution Authorizing Execution of the Lease**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome / Board Leadership
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Approval of the lease agreement enabling the school corporation to levy property taxes to pay lease payments to the non-profit building corporation, which acts as a pass-through to bondholders.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:05:05 Resolution Assigning Bids and Contracts**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution allowing the school corporation to award bids and contracts under state law and retain the right to assign them to the building corporation for payment processing using bond funds.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:06:26 Resolution Authorizing Third Supplement to Master Continuing Disclosure Undertaking and Issuance of Bonds**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution satisfying SEC requirements for school corporations issuing public bonds by committing to timely financial disclosures and material event notices.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *Note: General open public comment was noted as having no participants earlier in the agenda (00:09:04), and no general citizen forum took place near the conclusion of the meeting.*

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Dr. Reynolds reported on a smooth start to the school year, success in the marching band's summer season, and an upcoming recognition at the State Board of Education meeting regarding I-READ scores and high school redesign/freshman academy work.
 - Introduction of Jason Bullock as the new assistant principal at Grissom Elementary School.

- Mention of the passing of Sam Reid, former school board president and legislator.
 - Upcoming public hearing for additional appropriations scheduled for August 26.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote at [01:11:46](#).
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